



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

heyopādeyavirahādevaṃ harṣaviṣādayoḥ |
abhāvādadya he brahmannevamevāhamāsthitaḥ | 12 | 4 | |
āśramānāśramaṃ dhyānaṃ cittasvīkṛtavarjanam |
vikalpaṃ mama vīkṣyaitairevamevāhamāsthitaḥ | 12 | 5 | |
karmānuṣṭhānamajñānādyathaivoparamastathā |
budhvā samyagidaṃ tattvamevamevāhamāsthitaḥ | 12 | 6 | |

— Aṣṭāvakraḡītā, Prakaraṇa 12 (Chapter 12), Verses 4-6

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

Discarding the very notion of acceptance or rejection, untouched by joy or sorrow, the enlightened one rests in the Self. "Today, O Brahman, I am situated thus," declares Ashtavakra. He emphasizes the freedom that comes from transcending the dualities that bind us. You, too, can find this liberation by recognizing the inherent completeness within, independent of external circumstances. It's a state of being where you are neither chasing fleeting pleasures nor running from perceived pains, understanding that both are simply ripples on the surface of the ocean of consciousness.

Observing the concepts of stages of life (ashramas), or the lack thereof, meditation, and the rejection of mental constructs, Ashtavakra again affirms his state: "I am situated thus." This speaks to the irrelevance of prescribed paths or rigid practices once the truth is realized. Your spiritual journey may involve various practices, but ultimately, the goal is to move beyond dependence on them, recognizing that the Self is ever-present, unconditioned by any specific method. It's about seeing through the illusion of needing to *do* something to *become* something you already are.

Performing actions, or ceasing from action, both stem from ignorance, but with awakened understanding of the true nature, one is situated thus. Ashtavakra highlights that both attachment to action and aversion to action arise from a lack of true knowledge. You might find yourself caught in cycles of striving and burnout, believing that your worth is tied to your productivity. True liberation lies in acting from a place of awareness, free from the compulsion of ego-driven desires and fears. When you understand that your essence is beyond the realm of action and inaction, you can move through life with grace and equanimity.

This wisdom invites you to shed the layers of conditioning that obscure your inherent peace. It's about recognizing the freedom that comes from not being defined by your experiences, your roles, or your achievements. Can you embrace this profound simplicity and rest in the awareness of your true Self, just as you are, right now?

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

How can you apply the understanding of transcending acceptance and rejection to a challenging situation you are currently facing?